PPP-C-1128A
November 2, 1972
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PPP-C-001128(GSA-FSS)
December 8, 1965 and
MIL-C-43425
26 April 1966
(see 6.3)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CONTAINER ASSEMBLY, SAMPLE AND SPECIMEN SHIPPING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cylindrical tube-type containers used for mailing samples and specimens for medical analysis (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Container assemblies shall be of the following types and sizes (outer container inside dimensions in inches), specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Chipboard container without inner container

Size 1 - 4-3/8 long by 1-1/2 I. D.

Type II - Chipboard container with aluminum inner container

Size 2 - 5-3/8 long by 1-1/4 I. D.
Size 3 - 3-3/4 long by 1-3/4 I. D.
Size 4 - 3-5/8 long by 2 I. D.
Size 5 - 7-1/4 long by 1-1/4 I. D.

Type III - Chipboard container with tinplate inner container

Size 6 - 5-3/8 long by 2-3/8 I. D.
Size 7 - 8-3/8 long by 2-3/4 I. D.
Size 8 - 8-3/8 long by 3-3/4 I. D.

FSC 8110

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

QQ-T-425	-	Tinplate (Hot Dip and Electrolytic).
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665	-	Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Set-up.
PPP-T-495	-	Tubes, Mailing and Filing.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall conform to the applicable specifications and requirements specified herein.

3.1.1 Aluminum. Aluminum shall be commercial alloy, number 1050 or 1100.

3.1.2 Tinplate. Tinplate shall conform to type II, grade 3, class A, or grade 4, class 25, bright finish of QQ-T-425. The base weight of tinplate for walls shall be 85 to 90 pounds per base box.

3.1.3 Newsboard. Liners for inner container caps shall have a total thickness of not less than 0.045 inches and be made of water resistant coated newsboard.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Dimensions. The outer containers shall conform to dimensions specified in table I. The type II inner containers shall conform to table II. The type III inner containers shall conform to table III.

TABLE I. Dimensions of outer containers (inches)

Types I, II, and III outer container size	I.D. ± 1/16	Inside length ± 1/8	Material thickness + 0 - .005
1	1-1/2	4-3/8	.105
2	1-1/4	5-3/8	.080

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TABLE I. Dimensions of outer containers (inches) (cont'd)

Types I, II, and III outer container size	I.D. ± 1/16	Inside length ± 1/8	Material thickness + 0 - .005
3	1-3/4	3-3/4	.080
4	2	3-5/8	.080
5	1-1/4	7-1/4	.105
6	2-3/8	5-3/8	.105
7	2-3/4	8-3/8	.105
8	3-3/4	8-3/8	.105

TABLE II. Dimensions of type II inner containers (inches)

Type II inner container (aluminum) size	O.D. ± 1/32	Outside length ± 1/16	Material thickness + 0 - .003
2	1	5	.013
3	1-1/2	3-5/8	.018
4	1-3/4	3-7/16	.018
5	1	7-1/8	.015

TABLE III. Dimensions of type III inner containers (inches)

Type III inner container (tinplate) size	O.D. ± 1/32	Outside length ± 1/8	Material thickness + 0 - .005
6	2-3/16	5-1/4	.0099
7	2-5/8	8-1/4	.0099
8	3-5/8	8-1/4	.0099

3.2.2 Type I, outer container. The outer container assembly shall be a cylindrical chipboard mailing tube with metal screw cap conforming to type I, class I, style c of PPP-T-495, except wall thickness shall be as specified in table I. The inner surface of the cylinder shall be coated with paraffin or polyethylene. The container shall be provided with a single faced corrugated fiberboard pad, cut to fit the bottom, and a paper disc to fit the cover. The

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metal end crimp shall withstand a minimum load of 25 pounds applied to the axis of the tube, when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.2.3 Types II and III container inner body (sizes 2 thru 8). The inner container shall be constructed of materials as specified in 3.1.1 or 3.1.2, as applicable (see 1.2). The aluminum containers shall be made in one piece, seamless, cylindrical in shape, and open on the top. The top of the container shall be curled inward. The top portion shall have a thread that is compatible with the cap.

3.2.3.1 Inner container cap. Inner container caps shall be constructed of materials specified in 3.1.2. The cap shall be curled below the thread edge and knurled around the top edge. Threads shall be either continuous or interrupted to match the neck of the tube.

3.2.3.2 Leakage. Inner containers shall show no sign of leakage when tested as specified (see 4.3.2).

3.3 Workmanship. Containers shall be clean, free from scuffs, blisters, defective adhesion between layers, ragged cuts, and imperfect crimps. Metal edge crimps shall be smooth, free of sharp edges, and burrs. Screw caps shall be free from cracks, sharp edges, and burrs.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 End item inspection. The lot shall consist of all containers of the same classification offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one container assembly.

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4.2.2.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for defects in table IV. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 for major and 10.0 for total defects, expressed as defects per 100 units.

TABLE IV. Visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Construction	Not cylindrical in shape	X	
	Inner surface not coated as specified (outer container)	X	
	Paper pad or disc missing (outer container)	X	
	Thread not compatible with cap	X	
	Top of container not curled below thread edge (inner container)	X	
	Aluminum container not seamless drawn	X	
	Closure missing	X	
	Cap not curled or knurled, when required	X	
	Metal ends not double crimped, when required	X	
Workmanship	Tubes not clean		X
	Not well formed		X
	Surface scuffs and blisters		X
	Ragged cuts		X
	Imperfect crimps, burrs, cracks, and sharp edges		X

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for dimensions specified in table I. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerances shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 6.5, expressed as defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested as specified in 4.3 thru 4.3.2 as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packing and marking comply with section 5. Defects shall be as listed in Table V. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be all shipping containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE V. Examination for packaging, packing and marking

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping. Distortion of container.
Quantity per container	More or less than required.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Type I outer container stripping test. The outer container body shall be prepared by cutting a section of proper length for holding in a fixture shown in figure 1. Tension shall be applied at a rate of 0.25 plus or minus 0.05 inch per minute. Separation of the end at less than 25 pounds shall be cause for rejection (see 3.2.2). Alternate methods may be used when authorized by the contracting officer.

4.3.2 Types II and III container test leak test. The type II and III inner containers shall be filled with water and the cover screwed on tightly with the liner in place. The container shall then be inverted for 30 minutes. Evidence of leakage shall be cause for rejection (see 3.2.3.2).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Container assemblies of one type and size only shall be packaged in the quantities as specified in table VI in a snug-fitting fiberboard or folding or setup paperboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636; variety 1, styles III, IV or VIII, type B, class a of PPP-B-566; or type I, variety 1, class A, style 2 of PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification (see 6.3)

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TABLE VI. Packaging and packing quantities

Container Length	Container Diameter	No. per unit package	No. per shipping container
4-3/8	1-1/2	12	144
5-3/8	1-1/4	12	144
3-3/4	1-3/4	12	144
3-5/8	2	12	144
5-3/8	2-3/8	12	144
8-3/8	2-3/4	None	72
8-3/8	3-3/4	None	72
7-1/8	1	12	144

5.1.2 Level C. The container assembly shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against physical and environmental damage during shipment, handling and limited storage. The manufacturer's commercial practice is acceptable when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Container assemblies of one type and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the quantities as specified in table VI in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c, or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing by means of tape, and reinforcing with flat steel strapping or tape banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified (see 5.2.2.1), container assemblies of one type and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the quantities as specified in table VI in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), weather-resistant fiberboard specified in 5.2.1 shall be used for the shipping container. Closure shall be as specified in 5.2.2.

5.2.3 Level C. The container assemblies shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

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5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Tubes conforming to this specification are intended primarily for the mailing of biological specimens and similar substances.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size required (see 1.2).
(c) Level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Quantity of containers per package for level A (see 5.1.1).

6.3 Supersession data. MIL-C-43425 and PPP-C-001128, due to their similarities, have been combined into this specification. The classification comparison among PPP-C-001128, MIL-C-43425 and this specification is as follows:

PPP-C-1128A	PPP-C-001128	MIL-C-43425
Type I, size 1		Type I, size 1
Type II, size 2	Tube No. 1	
Type II, size 3	Tube No. 2	
Type II, size 4	Tube No. 3	
Type II, size 5		Type II, size 2
Type III, size 6	Tube No. 4	
Type III, size 7	Tube No. 5	
Type III, size 8	Tube No. 6	
Deleted		Type II, size 3
Deleted		Type II, size 4
Deleted		Type III, size 5

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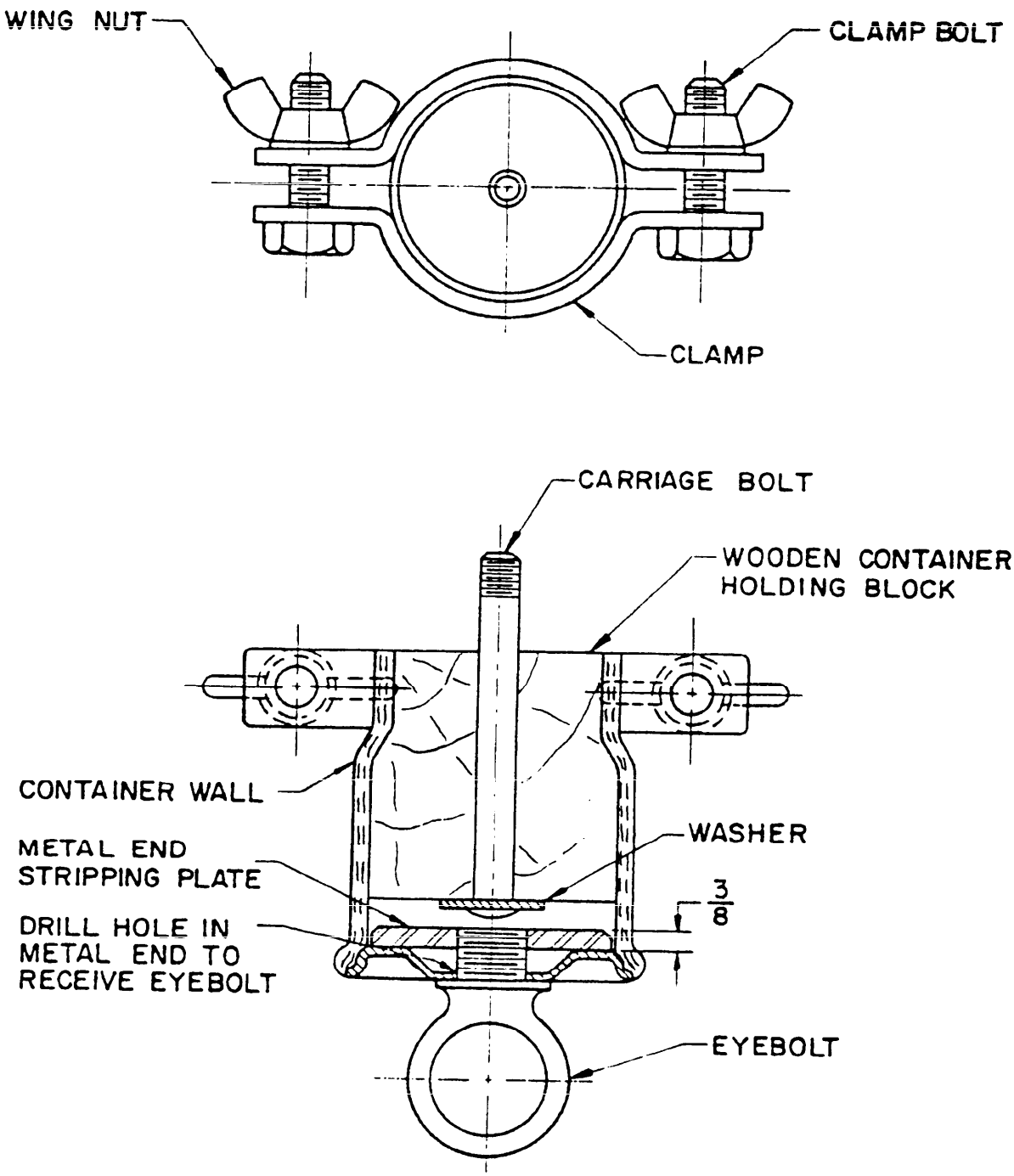


FIGURE I
STRIPPING, METAL END

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

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INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

Container Assembly, Sample And Specimen Shipping PPP-C-1128A

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

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